

The Later Mughals (1707–1862)

From Bahadur Shah I to Bahadur Shah Zafar — nicknames, murders, invasions, and how each emperor lines up with Plassey, Panipat III and Buxar

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Why this chapter matters: After Aurangzeb's death in 1707, ten emperors sat on a rapidly weakening Mughal throne in just 150 years. SSC loves this chapter because each ruler has one unforgettable nickname or single defining event — once you anchor a ruler to their "gimmick", the whole sequence becomes trivia you'll never forget.

1 The Full Sequence — Later Mughals 🔥

MEMORY TRICK

"**Bad Judges Fail; Many Assess Anyone's Sad Behaviour**" — Bahadur Shah I → Jahandar Shah → Farrukhsiyar → Muhammad Shah → Ahmad Shah Bahadur → Alamgir II → Shah Alam II → Akbar II → Bahadur Shah II (Zafar).

Emperor	Tenure	One-line "hook"
Bahadur Shah I	1707–1712	"Shah-e-Bekhabar" — the careless/unaware emperor
Jahandar Shah	1712–1713	"Lampat Murkh" — married the courtesan Lal Kunwar
Farrukhsiyar	1713–1719	"Ghrinit Kayar" — murdered by the Sayyid Brothers
Muhammad Shah	1719–1748	"Rangeela Raja" — Nadir Shah's invasion (1739)
Ahmad Shah Bahadur	1748–1754	Ahmad Shah Abdali's first invasion (1748)
Alamgir II	1754–1759	Battle of Plassey happened in his reign (1757)
Shah Alam II	1759–1806	Panipat III (1761), Buxar (1764), Treaty of Allahabad (1765)
Akbar II	1806–1837	Gave Raja Ram Mohan Roy the title "Raja"
Bahadur Shah II (Zafar)	1837–1857	Last Mughal emperor; died in exile, 1862, Rangoon

Note: Two very short-lived rulers, Rafi-ud-Darajat and Rafi-ud-Daula, briefly held the throne in 1719 between Farrukhsiyar and Muhammad Shah — usually skipped in exam-level sequencing questions, but good to recognise as distractor names.

PYQ: Correct chronological order — Bahadur Shah, Jahandar Shah, Farrukhsiyar, Muhammad Shah, Shah Alam? **Ans: Correct as listed (Option "C" in the source MCQ)**

2 Bahadur Shah I — "Shah-e-Bekhabar"

The first Later Mughal (also referred to in some sources as **Shah Alam I**), ruled **1707–1712**. Historian **Vincent Smith** gave him the label "**Shah-e-Bekhabar**" (the careless/unaware emperor) for his general indifference and negligence — though he also pursued relatively conciliatory policies toward the Marathas and Rajputs.

3 Jahandar Shah — "Lampat Murkh"

Jahandar Shah (1712–1713) earned the label "**Lampat Murkh**" ("debauched fool") because he married **Lal Kunwar**, a well-known courtesan/dancer of Delhi. His incompetence and this scandal cost him the throne — with the help of his uncle's faction, he was overthrown. Real power during his short reign lay with his wazir, **Zulfiqar Khan**.

4 Farrukhsiyar — "Ghrinit Kayar" 🔥

Farrukhsiyar (1713–1719) is remembered as "**Ghrinit Kayar**" ("despicable coward"). He was deposed and murdered in **1719** by the powerful **Sayyid Brothers**, with the crucial military support of the Rajput ruler **Ajit Singh**. He was blinded (with a needle) before his execution — a brutal end.

⚠ **Contradiction flagged**

The lecture calls Ajit Singh the "ruler of Mewar". This is incorrect — **Ajit Singh Rathore was the ruler of Marwar (Jodhpur)**, in present-day Rajasthan, not Mewar (which was ruled by the Sisodia dynasty from Udaipur). Marwar and Mewar are two separate, often rival, Rajput kingdoms — don't mix them up.

5 Muhammad Shah — "Rangeela Raja"

Muhammad Shah (1719–1748) was nicknamed "**Rangeela Raja**" ("the colourful/flamboyant king") for his indulgent, pleasure-seeking lifestyle rather than governance. Key events of his reign:

- **Jizya tax** was abolished during his reign (though whether this was truly its final abolition is debated — some sources note later, more complete removals).
- **Nadir Shah's invasion of Delhi** took place in **1739**, during his reign — Nadir Shah looted the city, including the famous **Peacock Throne**.

⚠ **Contradiction flagged**

The lecture states that Muhammad Shah married **Indira Kanwar**, Ajit Singh's daughter. Historical sources are consistent that **Indira Kanwar (Bai Indira Kanwar) married Farrukhsiyar** in 1715 — not Muhammad Shah. This appears to be a mix-up between two consecutive emperors in the lecture.

6 The Peacock Throne & the Kohinoor

The **Peacock Throne** was built under **Shah Jahan** and famously had the **Kohinoor diamond** set into it. In **1739**, **Nadir Shah** looted Delhi, dismantled the throne, and carried it (and the Kohinoor) off to **Persia**.

7 Ahmad Shah Bahadur & Abdali's First Invasion

Ahmad Shah Bahadur ruled **1748–1754**. **Ahmad Shah Abdali's first invasion of India** occurred in **1748**, during his reign. Abdali's repeated plundering raids gave rise to a Punjabi saying roughly translating to: "*Eat and drink what you have — whatever's left, Ahmad Shah will take away.*"

8 Alamgir II — Reign of Plassey

Alamgir II (1754–1759) was the nominal Mughal emperor when the **Battle of Plassey (1757)** was fought between Robert Clive and Siraj-ud-Daulah — a key cross-reference between the "Later Mughals" and "Expansion of British Rule" chapters.

9 Shah Alam II — The Emperor of Three Great Battles 🔥

Shah Alam II's long reign (**1759–1806**) nominally overlaps with three of the most-tested battles in the whole syllabus:

Event	Year
Third Battle of Panipat	1761
Battle of Buxar	1764
Treaty of Allahabad (Diwani grant)	1765

Later, in **1788**, the wazir **Ghazi-ud-Din** refused to let Shah Alam II enter Delhi. Ghazi-ud-Din was murdered soon afterwards.

During the Third Battle of Panipat (1761): when the invader Ahmad Shah Abdali refused to leave Delhi, the Jat ruler of Bharatpur, **Suraj Mal**, made efforts to force his retreat. A popular saying credits Jat valour: paraphrased, "a mother of the Jats gives birth to a hero, and with a sword like Suraj Mal's, one conquers Delhi." Abdali is said to have finally left Delhi only after Suraj Mal himself withdrew from the campaign back to Bharatpur.

PYQ: The Battle of Buxar (1764) took place during which Mughal emperor's reign? **Ans: Shah Alam II**

10 Akbar II & Raja Ram Mohan Roy

Emperor **Akbar II** (1806–1837) conferred the title "**Raja**" on the social reformer **Ram Mohan Roy** — hence "Raja Ram Mohan Roy".

11 Bahadur Shah II (Zafar) — The Last Emperor

Bahadur Shah Zafar (r. 1837–1857) was the last Mughal emperor. After the Revolt of 1857, the British exiled him to **Rangoon (Yangon, Burma)**, where he died in **1862**.

Homework question from the lecture (worth knowing): Who *completely and finally* abolished the Jizya tax across the empire? This is left as an open/debated point in the sources — different textbooks credit different rulers depending on region and period, so treat any single-name answer with caution unless your specific exam's official key says otherwise.

12 Bibi Ka Maqbara

Bibi Ka Maqbara — often called the "Taj of the Deccan" for its visual resemblance to the Taj Mahal — is located in **Aurangabad** (renamed **Chhatrapati Sambhaji Nagar** in recent years), in Maharashtra. It was built for **Dilras Banu Begum**, wife of **Aurangzeb**, who was posthumously given the title **Rabia-ud-Daurani**. Construction was started by **Aurangzeb** and completed by his son, **Azam Shah**.

13 François Bernier — Dara Shikoh's Physician

The French traveller **François Bernier** served as physician to Prince **Dara Shikoh** (Shah Jahan's eldest son) and wrote *Travels in the Mughal Empire*. Common MCQ distractors: **Jean-Baptiste Tavernier** (associated with Shah Jahan's court generally), **Niccolò de' Conti** and **Marco Polo** (both associated with Vijayanagara/South India, much earlier).

14 Awadh Under the Later Mughals

- Awadh came under Mughal control during **Humayun's** reign — indirectly, with no major recorded battle.
- Its first governor was **Saadat Khan** (Saadat Ali Khan), a **Persian** noble — later regarded as the **first Nawab of Awadh**.
- Saadat Khan died in **1739** of a heart attack, triggered by the shock of **Nadir Shah's attack on Delhi** that same year.
- Besides Faizabad, the Awadh Nawabs also controlled **Lucknow** (not Meerut or Bundelkhand, which were never under their control).

15 Madad-e-Maash

Madad-e-Maash ("aid for a living") referred to **revenue-free land grants given to scholars** and learned men under Mughal administration — not a toll tax, a military pension, or a cultivation tax (common wrong options).

16 Mughals vs the British — the First Clash

The **first Mughal ruler to fight against the British** was **Aurangzeb**, who attempted (unsuccessfully) to expel the English from their trading posts — this refers to what is separately known as the **Anglo-Mughal War (1686–90)**, during which the English governor **Sir John Child** was expelled (covered in Part 2).

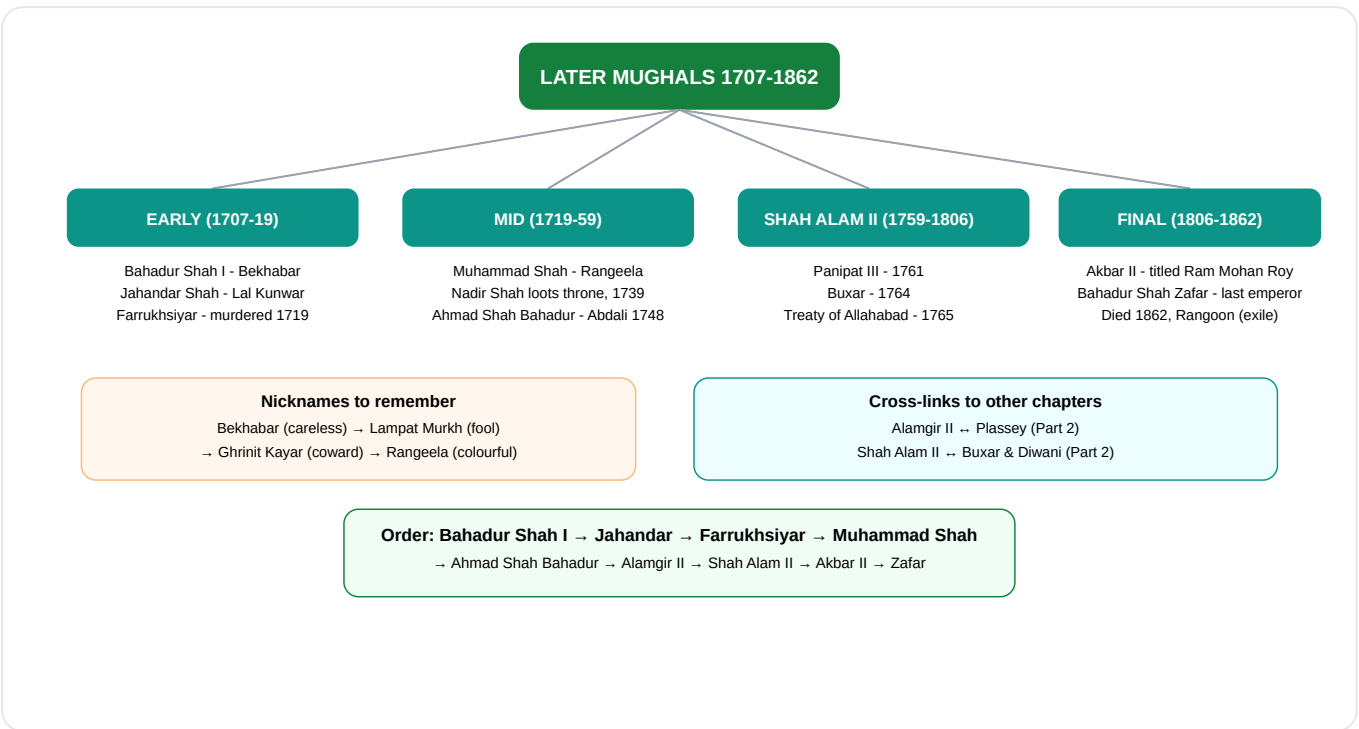
Earlier Mughal-English links (revision from Part 1/2): William **Hawkins** was honoured with the title "**Khan**" by **Jahangir** in 1608 (hence "English Khan"). Ambassador **Sir Thomas Roe** arrived at Jahangir's court in **1615**, during Jahangir's reign (1605–1627).

17 Master Reference Table

Superlative / Record	Answer
First Later Mughal ruler	Bahadur Shah I, 1707–1712
"Shah-e-Bekhabar"	Bahadur Shah I (named by Vincent Smith)
"Lampat Murkh"	Jahandar Shah (married Lal Kunwar)
"Ghrinit Kayar"	Farrukhsiyar (murdered 1719)
"Rangeela Raja"	Muhammad Shah

Superlative / Record	Answer
Emperor during Nadir Shah's invasion	Muhammad Shah, 1739
Emperor during Abdali's first invasion	Ahmad Shah Bahadur, 1748
Emperor during Battle of Plassey	Alamgir II, 1757
Emperor during Panipat III / Buxar / Allahabad Treaty	Shah Alam II (1761 / 1764 / 1765)
Gave Ram Mohan Roy the title "Raja"	Akbar II
Last Mughal emperor; died where	Bahadur Shah Zafar; Rangoon, 1862
Bibi Ka Maqbara built for	Dilras Banu Begum (title: Rabia-ud-Daurani)
Dara Shikoh's physician	François Bernier
First Nawab of Awadh	Saadat Khan (Persian)
Madad-e-Maash	Revenue-free land grants to scholars
First Mughal to fight the British	Aurangzeb (unsuccessful)

18 Mind Map — Later Mughals



19 30-Second Revision

Fact	Value
Bekhabar / Lampat Murkh / Ghrinit Kayar	Bahadur Shah I / Jahandar Shah / Farrukhsiyar
Rangeela Raja + Nadir Shah invasion	Muhammad Shah, 1739
Abdali's first invasion	1748, under Ahmad Shah Bahadur
Plassey emperor	Alamgir II, 1757
Panipat III / Buxar / Allahabad	Shah Alam II — 1761 / 1764 / 1765
Bibi Ka Maqbara	Aurangabad; for Dilras Banu Begum
Dara Shikoh's physician	François Bernier
Last Mughal emperor	Bahadur Shah Zafar, d. 1862, Rangoon

1. When did Shah Alam II grant Bengal's Diwani to the East India Company?

Ans: 1765, via the Treaty of Allahabad

2. Where is Bibi Ka Maqbara located?

Ans: Aurangabad (Chhatrapati Sambhaji Nagar)

3. Who built Bibi Ka Maqbara and for whom?

Ans: Started by Aurangzeb, completed by his son Azam Shah, for wife Dilras Banu Begum

4. Identify the correct order of the Later Mughals.

Ans: Bahadur Shah → Jahandar Shah → Farrukhsiyar → Muhammad Shah → Shah Alam (as sequenced)

5. What is Aurangabad's new (current) name?

Ans: Chhatrapati Sambhaji Nagar

6. Which foreign traveller was physician to Prince Dara Shikoh?

Ans: François Bernier

7. Who played an important role in the founding/establishment of Bengal?

Ans: Murshid Quli Khan (founder); Job Charnock founded Calcutta

8. Two decisive battles — Panipat III and Buxar — occurred under whose reign?

Ans: Shah Alam II

9. What does "Madad-e-Maash" refer to?

Ans: Revenue-free land granted to scholars

10. Who was the last Mughal emperor to sit on the Peacock Throne (i.e., have it as symbol of rule)?

Ans: The throne itself was looted by Nadir Shah in 1739, during Muhammad Shah's reign

11. Which Mughal ruler did wazir Ghazi-ud-Din stop from entering Delhi (1788)?

Ans: Shah Alam II

12. Which Englishman was honoured with the title "Khan" by Jahangir?

Ans: William Hawkins

13. During which Mughal emperor's reign did Thomas Roe arrive in India?

Ans: Jahangir (Roe arrived in 1615)

14. Which Mughal ruler first fought against the British?

Ans: Aurangzeb

15. Which Mughal emperor made Awadh part of the Mughal empire?

Ans: Humayun (indirectly, no major battle)

16. Besides Faizabad, which other UP region was under Awadh's Nawabs?

Ans: Lucknow

17. Who was Awadh's first Nawab, and how did he die?

Ans: Saadat Khan; died of a heart attack in 1739, triggered by Nadir Shah's attack on Delhi

18. Who was the last Mughal emperor to sit on the (Mughal) throne?

Ans: Bahadur Shah II (Zafar)

19. Where and when did Bahadur Shah Zafar die?

Ans: Rangoon, 1862

20. Which Mughal emperor gave Raja Ram Mohan Roy the title "Raja"?

Ans: Akbar II

21. Under whose reign was the Battle of Plassey fought?

Ans: Alamgir II

22. Under whose reign was the Third Battle of Panipat fought?

Ans: Shah Alam II

23. Under whose reign did Ahmad Shah Abdali attack for the first time?

Ans: Ahmad Shah Bahadur, 1748

24. Under whose reign did Nadir Shah invade India?

Ans: Muhammad Shah, 1739

25. Which Mughal ruler is called "Shah-e-Bekhabar", and by whom?

Ans: Bahadur Shah I; named so by historian Vincent Smith

26. Which Mughal ruler is called "Lampat Murkh"?

Ans: Jahandar Shah

27. Which Mughal ruler is called "Ghrinit Kayar"?

Ans: Farrukhsiyar

28. What is Muhammad Shah's popular nickname?

Ans: Rangeela Raja

21 Extra Practice (Beyond the Video)

E1. Who actually murdered/deposed Farrukhsiyar in 1719, alongside Ajit Singh?

Ans: The Sayyid Brothers (Abdullah Khan and Hussain Ali Khan)

E2. Which kingdom did Ajit Singh actually rule?

Ans: Marwar (Jodhpur) — not Mewar

E3. Who did Ajit Singh's daughter, Indira Kanwar, actually marry?

Ans: Farrukhsiyar (in 1715) — not Muhammad Shah

E4. Which two short-lived emperors briefly ruled in 1719, between Farrukhsiyar and Muhammad Shah?

Ans: Rafi-ud-Darajat and Rafi-ud-Daula

E5. What was the Kohinoor's fate after Nadir Shah's 1739 invasion?

Ans: Taken to Persia along with the dismantled Peacock Throne

E6. Under which act did the Mughal emperor's role become purely titular after 1803?

Ans: After the Second Anglo-Maratha War, the British took Delhi (1803) and the Mughal emperor became a British pensioner in all but name

E7. What year did the British formally end the Mughal dynasty's rule, and how?

Ans: 1857–58, after the revolt; Bahadur Shah Zafar was tried and exiled in 1858

22 Bonus — Standard-Syllabus Points (Not in the Video)

Commonly tested alongside "Later Mughals" but not explicitly covered in the lecture. Verified against standard references.

- **1803 — Second Anglo-Maratha War:** The British took control of Delhi and the Mughal emperor Shah Alam II effectively became a British pensioner, though he retained the throne in name until 1857 — an important bridge between "Later Mughals" and "Expansion of British Rule".
- **Nizam-ul-Mulk Asaf Jah I:** A powerful noble under the Later Mughals who broke away to found the independent state of **Hyderabad** in 1724 — a classic example of a Mughal governor becoming a de facto independent ruler, exactly like Murshid Quli Khan did in Bengal (Part 2).
- **Jat power under Churaman and Suraj Mal:** The Bharatpur Jats grew into a significant regional power during this same period of Mughal decline — covered in depth in the next chapter, "Marathas, Rajputs and Jats" (Part 4).
- **Trial of Bahadur Shah Zafar (1858):** Conducted by the British at the Red Fort after the 1857 revolt, on charges including rebellion against the Crown — leading directly to his exile to Rangoon.

Cross-check all dates with your NCERT Class VII "Our Past II" (Mughal decline) and Class VIII/XII sources for the standard textbook framing.
This is **Part 3 of an 8-part series** covering the full lecture. Marathas, Rajputs & Jats are covered next in **Part 4**.